

Working Effectively in Schools Unit 4

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Unit 4 Overview

- Inclusive Education
- Roles and Responsibilities
- Collaborative Planning and Problem-solving
- IEPs
- Communicating with Parents
- Maintaining Boundaries and Confidentiality
- Professionalism/Roles and Responsibilities

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You are not in this alone!

- School Based Teams
- Case Managers
- Learning support Teachers
- Administrators
- Non-enrolling school and student supports
- District Supports
- Outside agencies

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Inclusive Education Services Mission Statement

The Burnaby School District's Inclusive Education team works collaboratively with schools and parents to create supportive, inclusive, and caring communities where all children, specifically those children who have disabilities or diverse abilities, can reach their full potential. The Education Assistant is part of the collaborative instructional team that facilitates and encourages academic and social independence, and inclusion for the students they support.

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The Inclusive Education Team Believes In:

- Valuing the uniqueness of each child; their strengths and contributions;
- Creating partnerships with the home and community to support the education of each child;
- Supporting diversity as a natural and inherent condition of the school environment;
- Striving to create an effective, inclusive learning environment for each child;
- Providing access to appropriate educational environments that meet the individual needs of each child; and
- Having high expectations and monitoring results for each child.

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Education Assistant Beliefs

The value of Education Assistants and the complexity of their roles are recognized as important to the success of both schools and students in the Burnaby School District. Education Assistants play an active and essential role in their work with children and youth by providing encouragement, support, assistance, and advocacy.

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Education Assistants:

- Are respected and valued members of the educational team.
- Play a key role in the social, emotional, academic, and vocational success of children and youth with diverse abilities and disabilities.
- Work to foster independence in students, and engage them in community, classroom, and small group activities with their peers.
- Facilitate social skills and peer interactions as part of an inclusive education.
- Have a professional identity and advocate for their profession by maintaining positive, supportive, cooperative and professional relationships.
- Seek out opportunities to grow professionally by participating in on-going training, in-service and professional development.

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Collaboration

Collaboration has become an integral part of today's school culture. Collaboration encompasses an interactive process, where there is a genuine shared ownership for decision-making. Collaborative team members work together to identify student strengths and needs, develop plans, share expertise and perspectives, coordinate and implement services, and provide each other with support.

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School Based Team

A school-based team is an on-going team of school-based personnel which has a formal role to play as a problem-solving unit in assisting classroom teachers to develop and implement instructional and/or management strategies and to co-ordinate support resources for students with diverse learning needs within the school.

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School Based Team

Discussion

A planning meeting has been scheduled for your student and it is to complete:

- An FBA (Functional Behaviour Assessment)
- A PBS (Positive Behaviour Support Plan)
- A Safety Response Plan

What is your role:

- Before
- During
- After the meeting?

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Referral Process for DLST

1. Student is demonstrating behaviours of concern or is not responding to regular classroom instruction.
2. Classroom Teacher differentiates instruction and/or implements classroom strategies to support this student.
3. Behaviours of concern persist. Classroom teacher informs parents that he/she will be consulting with the school-based LS Teacher and/or School-Based Learning Support Team.

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Referral Process for DLST

3. Strategies and supports developed through SBLST are implemented for a period of time. Data is collected.
4. Behaviours of concern persist. Case Manager/LS Teacher requests District LST involvement. Classroom teacher informs parents of request for District Staff consultation.

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Communicating with Parents



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Parents & Communicating with Schools

- A parent's first point of contact at the school should always be the Classroom Teacher. The Classroom Teacher may consult with the Learning Support Teacher and/or the School-Based Team.
- Where an EA is involved in a child's daily program, it is best for parents to address any concerns with the teacher(s).
- The Classroom Teacher(s) are ultimately responsible for the educational programming of a child so it is vitally important that they know directly from the parent what questions or concerns that they may have.

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Parents & Communicating with Schools

- Depending on the level of need of a child, the Learning Support Teacher may be more "front line" with a child's educational program and therefore could be a good first contact.
- This can be discussed with the child's school team. In the rare situation that you find that a parent's questions or concerns have not been addressed by the Classroom or Learning Support Teacher, their next point of contact is the school Principal or Vice-Principal

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Parents – Steps to Follow

What do parents do if they have a concern about their child's educational program?

STEP ONE: If a parent has a question or concern about their child's academic and/or social emotional well-being at school, they should talk to the Classroom Teacher. The Classroom Teacher may consult with the Learning Support Teacher and/or the School-Based.

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Parents – Steps to Follow

STEP TWO: If after talking to the Classroom or Learning Support Teacher the parent still has a concern, then they should speak with the Principal or Vice-Principal.

If they still have a concern after speaking with the Principal or Vice-Principal, then they should call the Director of Instruction, Learning Services.

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What are some common sources of anger in parents?

Legitimate Concern

- The parent legitimately feels that their child's rights are being violated. This could be based on truth or there could be a misunderstanding

Learned Behavior

- The parent has learned to get what they want by being aggressive. This may be the way they were raised to "get things done." These squeaky wheels just want to be heard.

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What are some common sources of anger in parents?

History of Negative School Experiences

- Past negative experiences with the school setting may have caused a general mistrust in the education process.

Personality Conflicts

- Is it their personality or communication style? Some people are aggressive by nature and thrive on conflict and drama

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Angry Parents – Ways to Redirect

1. Model appropriate behavior

- Use a calm tone and do not allow your voice to raise if they raise their voice. Continue to smile and speak calmly. Use non-threatening body language that shows that you are listening.

2. Validate their concerns

- Let them know right away that you understand that they are upset, and you would like to help. BUT
- You must redirect them to the teacher.
- **What can you say? Class discussion**

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Angry Parents – Ways to Redirect

Don't take it personally

- Remember that there are many reasons or motivations behind a parent's anger that often has nothing to do with you.

Set limits and boundaries

- You make the rules for the conversation. If an angry parent is shouting, you can tell them that you will not continue to listen unless they lower their voice.

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How to deal with Angry Parents, Colleagues and Students with Calm

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-r29ercoaig>

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Rethinking the Role of the Educational Assistant

1. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UIH7Dz3wMpQ>

2. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VqfmaCofuko>

3. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oJPXf8gFhVM>

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Teachers & Education Assistants – Joint Working Arrangements

Teacher	Shared	Education Assistants

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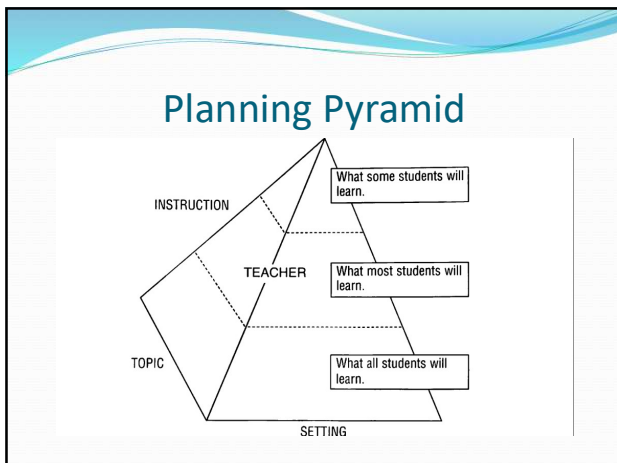
TEACHER	SHARED	TEACHER ASSISTANT
• Designs instructional program. • Develops IEPs. • Identifies responsibilities of individual members of student specific support teams in terms of participating in the development, implementation, and monitoring of the programs as described in the IEP. • Plans learning activities. • Determines appropriate modifications and adaptations in line with IEP goals. • Identifies the appropriate instructional learning resources. • When needed, advocates for the appropriate instructional learning resources. • Reviews and reinforces learning activities for concept and skill development.	• Discuss learners' strengths and weaknesses and consider best possible areas of program focus. • Attend program planning meetings, based on school and district policies, to assist with developing IEPs and transition plans for children and youth with special needs. • Discuss objectives and goals. • Discuss and clarify, on a regular basis, the ways in which the teacher assistants can assist the teacher with instructional programs, classroom management, and expectation setting for students. • Discuss adaptations and modifications to curriculum and resource materials. • Discuss what instructional learning resources are needed to reach IEP goals (e.g. flash cards, social stories, abacus, etc.). • Review learning resources together to clarify and share experiences and expectations.	• Shares relevant information about the performance and behavior of individual learners to support IEP goals, transition, and program design. • Gathers relevant information through working with student or students to provide feedback into the planning process. • Produces materials and implements strategies to accommodate individual learner needs/styles. • Assists with development of instructional learning resources. • Reviews and reinforces learning activities using lesson plans and learning strategies developed by the teacher/team to help students master concepts and skills.

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Response to Intervention (RTI)

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JL5piUZKTGo>

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Long Story Shortz - Universal Design for Learning

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z94KPmPufT8&ab_channel=LongStoryShortz

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Professionalism



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Professionalism

Discussion

1. What is it?
2. What are the qualities of a person acting in a professional manner?
3. What actions/behaviours would detract from professionalism when working in a school setting?

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Pitfalls

- Gossip
- Cliques
- Complacency
- Complaining
- Overreacting
- Boundary issues
- Lack of clarity about roles and responsibilities

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Professionalism & Ethical Considerations

- Education Assistants play a critical (crucial) role supporting an inclusive community of learners.
- Professionalism is an integral part of this role and includes many different characteristics.

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Skills and Knowledge

An Educational Assistant pursues opportunities to develop skills and knowledge aligned with current best practice.

An EA:

- Challenges oneself through personal learning and growth
- Actively participates in District and school based Professional Development
- Accesses information and websites of district partners such as POPARD, POPFASD, ACTBC, SETBC, etc.
- Familiarizes themselves with SD41 policies and procedures, Burnaby's Learning Support Services Handbook, job description and Roles and Responsibilities of Teachers and Teacher Assistants/ Education Assistants document.

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Responsibility and Accountability

An Education Assistant is responsible, dependable, and accountable.

An EA:

- Arrives on time, prepared, and ready to follow the work schedule, including breaks
- Regularly checks district email
- Uses personal devices for personal use only during break time
- Demonstrates flexibility to demands and needs of the school and all related tasks

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Responsibility and Accountability

Hours of work and Break Times

- The administrator determines the start and end times of a shift based on the needs of a school
- EAs are expected to be at their workstation **ready to work** at the beginning of their shift and remain at workstation till the end of their shift
- EAs working a 5.5 hr shift are entitled to a **30 min** unpaid lunch and a paid **15 min** rest period (coffee break)
- EAs working a 4 hr shift are entitled to one paid **15 min** rest period (coffee break)
- Break periods cannot be combined or added to a lunch break, nor can they be taken at the beginning or at the end of a shift.

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Responsibility and Accountability

An Education Assistant is responsible, dependable, and accountable.

An EA:

- Uses Learning Improvement Fund (LIF) time to collaborate with colleagues to focus on planning and supporting students
- Uses professional feedback to enhance skills and abilities
- Contributes to a positive work environment

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Responsibility and Accountability

An Education Assistant is responsible, dependable, and accountable.

An EA:

- Advocates for safe implementation of activities and tasks while following guidelines established by the School/District to protect the wellbeing of children and youth
- Follows all plans designed for the student including the Individual Education Plans (IEPs), Functional Behavior Assessment (FBA), Positive Behaviour Support/Safety Response Plans (PBS/SRP)
- Follows procedures as laid out in care plans and reports provided by the Learning Support and Child Services Resource Team (CSRT).

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Responsibility and Accountability

How Addicted are you to your cell phone?



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Responsibility and Accountability

Social Media



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Ethics and Respect

An Education Assistant demonstrates ethical and respectful behaviour.

An EA:

- Strives to be supportive of others with respectful tone and feedback
- Respects other's ideas and perspectives
- Establishes cooperative, successful working relationships within the school community
- Establishes appropriate boundaries between co-workers, students, and families

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Ethics and Respect

An Education Assistant demonstrates ethical and respectful behaviour.

An EA:

- Protects private and confidential information about students, staff, and parents
 - Refers to students using only their initials when communicating via email
 - Only uses school district equipment to document student information and photographs
 - Respects and stays aware of location and nature of conversations

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Communication & Collaboration

Collaboration in Burnaby Schools includes teamwork, trust, open communication, and valued input by all.

An EA:

- Models respectful and effective verbal and non-verbal communication
- Understands that everyone has individual learning styles and communication needs
- Seeks to understand messages being communicated and asks questions when something is unclear
- Schedules time to communicate and collaborate with others

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Communication & Collaboration

Collaboration in Burnaby Schools includes teamwork, trust, open communication, and valued input by all.

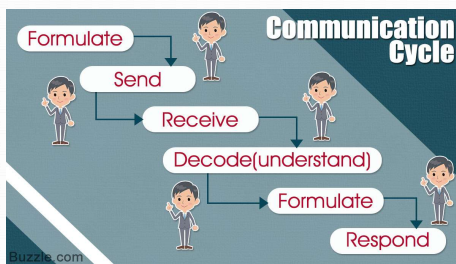
An EA:

- Provides information to teacher(s) for both formal and informal home/school communications
- Redirects parents' comments and questions pertaining to student progress or development, or any significant incidents that may have occurred during the day to the classroom teacher
- Observes, documents, and communicates with the team, the learner's strengths, achievements, and needs as related to the IEP goals

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Communication & Collaboration

Communication Systems



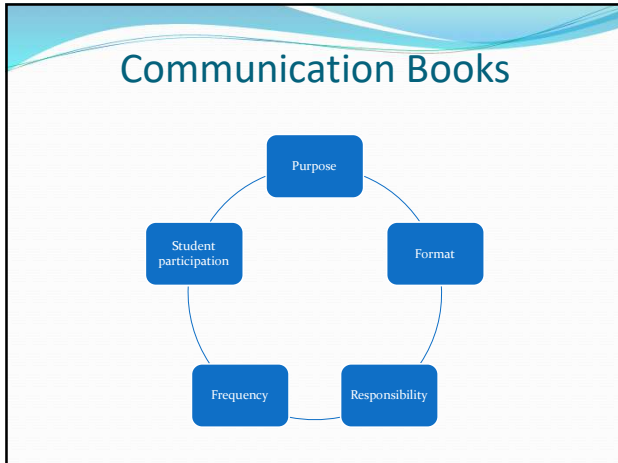
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Communication & Collaboration

Your Questions are More Important than Your Answers



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Communication Books

Jaume's Week! Week of:

How was your weekend?!	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
	Morning: R Y G B Breakfast:	Morning: R Y G B Breakfast:	Morning: R Y G B Breakfast:	Morning: R Y G B Breakfast:	Morning: R Y G B Breakfast:
	8:55 – 10:40	8:55 – 10:40	8:55 – 10:40	8:55 – 10:40	8:55 – 10:40
	10:55 – 12:15	10:55 – 12:15	10:55 – 12:15	10:55 – 12:15	10:55 – 12:15
	1:00 – 2:48	1:00 – 2:48	1:00 – 2:48	1:00 – 2:48	1:00 – 2:48
	Reminders:	Reminders:	Reminders:	Reminders:	Reminders:

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Communication Books

Today I...

Study

Walk

Bread Corner

Bibbity

Carpenter Time

Morning Walk

Library

Drink Water

Loving Board

Biology

Algebra

Resource Room

Friend Time

White Board

Comments / Highlight / Reminders:

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Communication Books

Date: _____

BLUE = tired/tad/hick GREEN = happy/cool/focused YELLOW = frustrated/loss of some control
RED = angry/yelling/out of control

At Home	
Sleep ☐ good sleep ☐ interrupted sleep # hours (approx) _____	Health ☐ fine ☐ cold ☐ sick Comments: _____
Breakfast What did he eat and how much? _____	
Zones Which zone did he spend the most time in this morning? Blue Green Yellow Red	
If he was upset, what was the trigger? _____	
Comments: _____	

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Communication Books

Things to consider:

1. Use of personal devices
2. Confidentiality – should only refer to the target student.
3. The child should only be expected to transport messages that enhance learning and connection to school community (should not be a book of shame)
4. Role of the student, EA, teacher: when will the communication book be read and by whom (is this built into the student's routine)
5. What do you do when parents do not complete the "home" communication?

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Developing Rapport with Students

Greeting and Leaving Rituals

Child focused



Adult focused



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Developing Rapport with Students

An Education Assistant engages with the school community respectfully and strives to establish rewarding and healthy relationships.

An EA:

- Initiates positive, effective, and cooperative interactions with students
- Establishes a mutual feeling of friendliness and trust
- Allows time and creates opportunities to build authentic relationships by focusing on the student's strengths, passions, needs, likes and dislikes
- Treats students in a respectful, reasonable, and fair manner
- Interacts with open body language such as facial expressions (smile), tone, eye contact and gestures

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Developing Rapport with Students

An Education Assistant engages with the school community respectfully and strives to establish rewarding and healthy relationships.

An EA:

- Demonstrates empathy and patience by showing an understanding of varying abilities, learning and communication styles
- Advocates for and supports others to understand students' abilities and learning styles
- Remembers to have fun ☺

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Developing Rapport with Students

School Staff are the Best App!

- Relationships between adults and students are the most important factor in promoting safe, healthy, caring schools.
- Schools and school districts should continuously develop innovative strategies to make every student feel valued, respected, safe, wanted and connected.

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What can we do?

School Climate

One of the fundamentally important dimensions of school climate is relationships:

- How “connected” people feel to one another within the school.
- How connected the school is to the community.
- Respect for students, parents and communities.
- Attachment by students to at least one caring and responsible adult at school.

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What can we do?

Classroom Climate

The importance of classroom climate cannot be stressed enough. Classroom climates have important effects on students' perceptions and behaviours.

- Students who feel respected and connected tend to be healthier (both physically and mentally) and perform better academically.

There are two types of support provided in a classroom - emotional and instructional (or instrumental).

- Emotional support within the classroom is important for all students; but it is essential for students considered to be “high risk”.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

1. Proximity
2. Sameness
3. Belonging and Loyalty
4. Significance
5. Love
6. Being Known

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Proximity (1 Year old)**
- **A baby begins the journey** of attachment to the parent through contact, touch and closeness. As they grow and as parents send the message that they are loved and adored and that they like to be around them, this attachment gets stronger.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Sameness**
- **Around the age of two**, a child adds sameness. That is the desire to be like their parents. They mimic words, mannerisms and behaviors. It also helps the growing child to continue to feel connected to their parents when parents emphasize interests or inclinations that they share with them. Their desire for sameness is also an important element in their acquisition of language.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Belonging and Loyalty**
- **Around the age of three**, a child becomes preoccupied with belonging and loyalty, to be 'on the same side as', which is a different way of closeness, says Neufeld. Children of this age are possessive of their parents, pushing siblings off Mommy's lap, saying things like, "It's my Mummy." With bonding through loyalty, the child also begins wanting to do what we ask of them.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Significance**
- **around the age of four**
Connection deepens even more with the next stage: significance. By letting the child know, how special they are, that they are cherished for who they are, it fortifies the sense of closeness. The child's understanding of their significance is based on the understanding, that parents will hold close, what is precious to them.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Love**
- **Around the age of five**, the child moves into the fifth stage of attachment, which comes in form of emotional connectedness. Warm and affectionate feelings begin to help deepen the attachment. Now it is important that the child knows that the affectionate feeling parents have for them is not attached to accomplishment, achievements or behavior. This becomes a major factor in the formation of trust in the parent. A child who experiences this kind of emotional intimacy with the parent is able to tolerate much more physical separation and yet still manage to hold the parent close.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- **Being known age 6 onwards**
- And finally, the last stage — being known — is where – if all has gone well – the child from six on up tells parents their secrets. They wish to be seen, heard and accepted for who they are. The child wishes to be known, and desires to confide in the parent. They allow themselves to be known because of the significant safety they feel. If achieved in childhood, this stage is one which can be maintained throughout their entire life.

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

"Children do not experience our intentions, no matter how heartfelt. They experience what we manifest in tone and behavior."

(Gordon Neufeld and Gabor Mate, *Hold Onto Your Kids*)

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GORDON NEUFELD'S SIX STAGES OF ATTACHMENT

- What happens if a child missed developing one of these stages?
- Is there any way to catch up with that missed stage?
- How can we translate these principles into our development of rapport with the students we support?

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Instructional Support & Facilitating Student Independence

An Education Assistant provides effective support by implementing evidence-based techniques and strategies to facilitate student learning and skill development.

An EA:

- Creates a safe and welcoming environment which fosters engagement and student participation, and celebrates student independence
- Encourages students to make choices and communicate their needs
- Uses goals from the IEP to create opportunities for student independence
- Continues fading prompts and working towards the lowest level of prompting required to encourage student independence as outlined in the Prompting Hierarchy

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Strength-Based Approach

When you point out kids' strengths, they grow in confidence. They know you see them. You see the whole individual, not just an empty vessel that needs to be filled with your knowledge.

~ Laura Lenz



OUT OF PEDAGOGY

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Instructional Support & Facilitating Student Independence

An Education Assistant provides effective support by implementing evidence-based techniques and strategies to facilitate student learning and skill development.

An EA:

- Implements suitable reinforcements according to the plan and/or the classroom system
- Implements the use of strategies, practices, and interventions to encourage self-regulation
- Engages students in the use of assistive technology and other devices demonstrated by team professionals (SLPs, CSRT, LSS staff) to assist the student to communicate as well as access learning and participate with peers and adults

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Instructional Support & Facilitating Student Independence

An Education Assistant provides effective support by implementing evidence-based techniques and strategies to facilitate student learning and skill development.

An EA:

- Actively engages and supports students' learning processes across settings, people, and situations
- Allows students to make and learn from small mistakes
- Provides clear and consistent direction and follow through
- Facilitates peer teaching, coaching, and mentoring

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Working Toward Independence

- In your groups think of a skill, task or activity from the Assessment of Student Independence. (choose a school routine)
 - Imagine that the student's current level requires a Full Physical Prompt.
 - Consider what antecedent strategies you could implement to increase the student's level of independence. (No using verbal – we talk too much in schools)
 - Create a question such as:
 - How can I help a student with entry tasks in the morning? (hang up coat, backpack, give work to teacher, etc.
 - How can I help a student set up a journal page independently?
- How will you use data to determine if progress is being made or not? Present your ideas to the class.

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Progress Monitoring

Name: _____ Date: IEP Goals and Objectives _____

Goal	Level	Frequency	Notes
Goal 1: [Goal text]	Level 1	Frequency	Notes
Goal 2: [Goal text]	Level 2	Frequency	Notes
Goal 3: [Goal text]	Level 3	Frequency	Notes
Goal 4: [Goal text]	Level 4	Frequency	Notes
Goal 5: [Goal text]	Level 5	Frequency	Notes

Assessment: [Assessment text]

Keep in mind: [Keep in mind text]

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Data Collection

The LSS SharePoint contains sample templates for collecting information and/or data on IEP goals and objectives, and for collecting various types of behavioural data.

There are many ways to collect evidence of learning.

Teachers have a variety of ways and preferred methods for collecting evidence of learning. All students, including students with diverse abilities, should be included in classroom methods for collecting evidence of learning related to classroom lessons, activities, projects, etc.

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Data Collection

Students supported by Education Assistants will have a variety of suggested methods for collecting evidence of learning. Evidence of classroom learning as designed by the teacher is one method, others may include data collection of goals and objectives in the IEP, and/or data collection of behaviors identified in a Positive Behaviour Support Plan (PBS).

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Data Collection

Individual Education Plans will indicate methods for collecting evidence of learning and data that have been agreed upon by the school and extended team in the creation of the plans. If these methods are unclear, the Education Assistant will ask the teacher to explain and demonstrate the methods described.

Team collaboration is key. If your observation and work with a student indicates the need for the collection of information or data, discuss with the classroom and learning support teachers.

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Data Collection



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Following Plans



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Being Proactive in the Classroom

Scenarios

- The teacher is showing a 20 minute video.
- Your student that you typically support is away for the day.
- The class is participating in a body break (dance).
- The class has free time and the student you typically support doesn't need your assistance.

What do you do?

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Social and Behavioural Support

An Education Assistant uses a positive, proactive approach that fosters peer relationships, reduces challenging behaviours, and promotes academic engagement.

- Consistently implements positive behaviour support plans and collects evidence of progress to discuss with team
- Provides specific, positive, and genuine feedback to students
- Sets up and reviews predictable routines
- Models, teaches, and reinforces socially appropriate behaviour and social expectations using a variety of strategies that mirror classroom or school structures and strategies such as: role play, video modelling, peer modelling, social stories, etc.

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Social and Behavioural Support

Why practicing can help with emotional regulation.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cpR9FtoR_9M

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Social and Behavioural Support

An Education Assistant uses a positive, proactive approach that fosters peer relationships, reduces challenging behaviours, and promotes academic engagement.

- Contributes to the healthy development of students by supporting classroom activities that build strong and reliable social relationships
- Provides opportunities for students to practice self-monitoring and problem solving
- Reduces barriers that may limit student perspectives and participation in learning activities and social situations

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Social and Behavioural Support

An Education Assistant uses a positive, proactive approach that fosters peer relationships, reduces challenging behaviours, and promotes academic engagement.

- Empowers students to build confidence and self-esteem
- Facilitates opportunities to develop peer relationships throughout the school day during learning activities, classroom social structures, recess, and other naturally occurring opportunities.
- Seeks to understand the function of the behaviour
- Considers each day as a "Fresh Start"

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Social and Behavioural Support

5 Unhelpful Responses We Have to Escalated Kids

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e7NgvDH_w28

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Social and Behavioural Support

5 Unhelpful Responses We Have to Escalated Kids

Our responses can be challenging to someone we think we are trying to help.

1. Talking too much. (escalation lowers our cognitive skills)
2. Not giving time to think. (if you must talk don't talk again for at least 45 seconds)
3. Responding to the opposition. (oppositional behaviour often looks intentional – thinking stops opposition – responses fuel them)
4. Using a loud volume or intense tone of voice. (use a soft and gentle volume and tone of voice)
5. Bringing up punishments or consequences. (we feel if they could just understand they would stop the behaviour)

We can avoid these responses by having and practicing a plan ahead of time.

Nate Sheets Oregon Behaviour Consultation

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Social and Behavioural Support

Cognitive Support™ Introduction

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u3GxwPbJFoQ>

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Social and Behavioural Support

In the video we learned that Jennifer had challenging behaviour when returning home from school because she was expected to use cognitive skills that she doesn't have either in general or in the moment. Jennifer's parents changed their approach toward her to avoid triggering her.

Jennifer struggles with the Executive Functions:

- Transitioning
- Short term memory
- Receptive/Expressive Communication
- Emotional Regulation

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Social and Behavioural Support

Transitions – allowed more time and a visual outlining expectations

Short term memory – provided a visual and time to recall information (20 minutes)

Receptive/Expressive communication – provided a choice to answer verbally or write her answer down

Emotional Regulation – provided more time to transition allowing her brain to process the new environment

Nate Sheets Oregon Behaviour Consultation

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Visual Supports and Technology

An Education Assistant understands the importance of using visual supports and technology to facilitate communication, access learning, and develop meaningful relationships with peers and adults.

An EA:

- Understands the various types of visual supports and where to find information to further their knowledge and understanding. Basic visual supports used in Burnaby include: visual schedules, transitional visual supports including visual timers, First/Then work schedules, token boards, checklists, behaviour support visuals, social stories, contingency maps

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Visual Supports and Technology

An Education Assistant understands the importance of using visual supports and technology to facilitate communication, access learning, and develop meaningful relationships with peers and adults.

An EA:

- Understands that teaching and supporting students to use visual supports and technology on a daily basis moves students towards independence
- Requests support from team members to understand how to use, teach and support students with visuals and/or technology as indicated in students' plans.

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Visual Supports and Technology

An Education Assistant understands the importance of using visual supports and technology to facilitate communication, access learning, and develop meaningful relationships with peers and adults.

An EA:

- Engages students in the use of assistive technology and other devices demonstrated by the classroom teacher or other team professionals (SLPs, CSRT, LSS staff) to assist students to communicate, and to access learning and engage with peers and adults
- Provides information to the teacher/LST/team regarding student progress in the use of agreed upon visual supports and technology and discusses steps towards more independent use.

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Challenging Behaviour

Tier 1 Supports: School Wide/Classroom 80 – 90%

- Structure – visual supports
- Connect, connect, connect
- Design classroom space
- Teach transitions
- Teach self-regulation
- Adapt curriculum
- Use effective praise – genuine
- Use proximity
- Give positive attention – 4 positive for each negative (correction)
- Soft start – morning or after lunch

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Visuals

Long Story Shortz - Visuals

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sieZ7h6u3JM>

94

Challenging Behaviour

Tier 2 Targeted Supports 5 – 7%

- Give choice
- Front load
- Allow wait time – give direction and walk away
- Connect with students and other adults
- Incentives
- Visual schedules
- Small group support for social skills and self-regulation
- Adapt academic activities
- Adapt expectations

95

Choice

Closed Choice

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oTRFiHNVENo>

96

Challenging Behaviour

Tier 3 Target Support 3 – 5% Individualized Support

- Intensive skill development
- Long term
- Individualized program with adult support
- FBA
- IEP with behavior goals: detailed PBS or SRP

97

Break

Break vs Reward

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XEHtOUqXKjM>

98

Safety Considerations

- An Education Assistant collaborates with the team to ensure there are plans to keep staff and students safe.
- Uses and frequently refers to Positive Behaviour Support (PBS) and Safety Response Plans (SRP) to support learning, social and behavioural needs
- After training, demonstrated an understanding of Non-violent Crisis Intervention (NCI) strategies and techniques as outlined in students' Safety Response Plans
- Seeks clarification as needed to ensure that the use of any physical restraint NCI techniques is a last resort, and that all protocols are strictly followed according to the agreed upon safety response plan.

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Safety Considerations

An Education Assistant wears clothing appropriate for their assignment.

An EA:

- Wears supportive footwear with non-slip soles, closed toe, and made for physical activity
- Removes loose jewellery or piercings that can be grabbed by students
- Ties back long hair
- Wears clothing that allows for physical activity and
- Minimizes risk of potential injury by wearing clothing that is not easy to grab

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Administrative Tasks: Managing Resources and Technology Skills (Non-Instructional Support):

An Education Assistant collects, organizes, and shares relevant information required to support student development.

An EA:

- Creates and maintains an on-call folder (formerly known as a sub file) with current student information, plans and strategies
- Ensures on-call folder is readily available to the team and any on-call replacement with up-to-date daily schedule
- Records and tracks data, observations, checklists on students' progress and IEP goals

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Administrative Tasks: Managing Resources and Technology Skills (Non-Instructional Support):

An Education Assistant collects, organizes, and shares relevant information required to support student development.

An EA:

- Uses technology skills to support students' learning and school communication
- Knows where all student documentation is located (IEP, FBA, PBS/SRP, Care Plan)
- Understands roles and responsibilities of school and district staff
- Participates in Education Assistant meetings

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Administrative Tasks: Managing Resources and Technology Skills (Non-Instructional Support):

An Education Assistant collects, organizes, and shares relevant information required to support student development.

An EA:

- Uses **LIF time** according to guidelines provided by the Burnaby School District.
- Prepares materials and supports as required
- Completes assessment of student independence checklist each term in collaboration with the classroom teacher and learning support teacher.

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Inclusion

- Think of a time you believed you truly belonged somewhere
- Think of a time when you believed you did not belong or were ostracized from a group

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Inclusion

Inclusion Makes the World More Vibrant

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QXY5TyCUTlo>

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SPECIAL EDUCATION SERVICES A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines

Inclusion describes the principle that all students are entitled to equitable access to learning, achievement and the pursuit of excellence in all aspects of their education. The practice of **inclusion** is not necessarily synonymous with integration and goes beyond placement to include meaningful participation and the promotion of interaction with others.

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What is Inclusive Education?

“all children have the right to be a part of the life of the classroom – both socially and academically – and schools need to create programs that accommodate and celebrate diversity”

Katz, 2012, p. 9

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Social Inclusion

- Views each student as a valued, contributing member of the classroom
- Fosters a sense of self-worth, acceptance, and belonging

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Academic Inclusion

- Encourages engagement in grade-level curriculum & classroom learning activities
- Promotes interactive learning with peers
- Creates cognitive challenge

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Inclusive Education

“when people become intentional and creative about how disabled people might participate as they are now, feasible and exciting solutions emerge. We quickly realize that innovation delivers what rehabilitation promises”

-Norman Kun

Causton & Tracy-Bronson, 2014, p. xi

111

Supporting Inclusion

- Assist with personal care
- Provide physical assistance
- Facilitate development of skills identified as learning objectives on IEP
- Support development of the skills and behaviours necessary to fulfill the role of a student
- Facilitate access to classroom learning activities and the curriculum

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An Active Role - Participation

“Doing what everyone else is doing”

- participating in tasks and activities alongside and with peers, with or without modifications and accommodations

VERSUS

“fringe participation”

- when students with disabilities have a restricted role in the participation of the activity

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Using the IEP - Lunchtime Activity

Elementary

High School



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Using the IEP - Lunchtime Activity

- Use a sample IEP to complete the group activity:
 - Choose a goal that you could work toward at lunch time and what you would do to reach that goal.
 - Consider the student's interests, learning preference, strengths and stretches.
 - Consider the overall goals and big ideas.
- Include:
- Name of Group Members
 - Name of student with IEP
 - The goal chosen
 - What activity the student will engage in
 - What materials/antecedent strategies you will need/use
 - How you will include other students
 - Which of the student's strengths you are using
 - How this activity matches the goal

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Embedded Values that Guide our Support

- Independence – Not dependence
- Communication – Not a focus on challenging behaviour
- Teaching – Not behaviour management or modification
- Willing Participation – Not compliance

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Quality of Life Indicators

Quality of Life for All -- Inclusion Outreach BC

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oBnuUThsHPo>

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Shared Model of Support

- Who is the student
- What level of support is required
- Role of IEP
- Quality of Life Indicators – school day should be a series of meaningful routines in which the student has the opportunity to strengthen goals and objectives
- Always working toward independence
- Elastic approach - Vigotsky

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Five Quality of Life Indicators

- **Presence** is the sharing of the ordinary places that define community life.
- **Choice** is the experience of autonomy both in small, everyday matters and in large, life-defining matters. Personal choice defines and expresses individual identity.
- **Competence** is the opportunity to perform functional and meaningful activities with whatever level or type of assistance required.
- **Respect** is having a valued place among a network of people and valued roles in community life.
- **Inclusion** is the experience of being part of a growing network of personal relationships that includes close friends.

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Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Be temporarily left alone to supervise in the classroom.
- Work under indirect teacher/resource teacher supervision with individuals or groups of students.
- Have specific instructional and behaviour management responsibility for students, as outlined in the IEP(s).

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Operate without teacher direction.
- Substitute for teachers or have responsibility for a class.
- Decide which concepts and skills are to be taught.

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Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Be involved in team meetings regarding a specific student and communicate with team members on an ongoing basis.
- Facilitate the appropriate inclusion of students with special needs in regular classes **as outlined in the IEP(s)**.

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Be given responsibility for designing student programs/curriculum.
- Be given sole responsibility for the inclusion of student.

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Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Be assigned record keeping tasks relevant to student IEP(s).
- Aid the teacher in supervising students during assemblies and group field trips.

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Be responsible for student diagnosis, evaluation, or reporting.
- Take responsibility for arranging and supervising class field trips.

122

Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Transport and accompany students for community-based instruction as described in the IEP(s) and as covered by school district Field Trip Policy. You may agree to transport a child but can't be required to do so.

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Take student out of the class without knowledge and approval of the supervising teacher.

123

Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Communicate appropriately with parent(s) as specifically directed by Case Manager/A.O./Teacher, or as outlined in the IEP(s) (i.e. daily communication book).

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Communicate on their own accord with parent(s) about behavioural/ educational issues.

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Knowing Your Job

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY

- Provides personal care assistance, as directed by appropriate staff, such as toileting, feeding, diapering, and dressing; provides physical assistance, as directed by appropriate staff, such as wheelchair maneuvering, positioning, lifting and transferring.

CERTIFIED EDUCATION ASSISTANT MAY NOT

- Provide personal care or physical assistance outlined in a care/safety plan unless signed off by governing party.
EG – Nurse, OT, PT etc.

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Collaborating with Parents and Outside Agency Supports

- Experience of being heard
- Give parents something to brag about
- Be clear about personal and professional boundaries
- Know when to refer parents to higher level of authority

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Give Parents Something to Brag About



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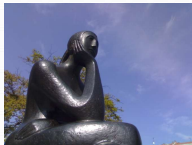
Questions



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Closing Activity

I used to think



And
Now I think

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